

PSY 254 Reading Period Office Hours

Monday 12/8	Tuesday 12/9	Wednesday 12/10	Thursday 12/11	Friday 12/12
11:30am-1:00pm PSH 217 (Kennedy)	10:00am-11:30am PSH 205 (Sarah)	10:00am-11:30am PSH 217 (Kennedy)	11:30am-1:00pm PSH 205 (Sarah)	10:30am-12:00pm PSH 224 (Chantal)
1:00-4:00pm PSH 319 (Claire)	2:30pm-5:30pm PSH 226 (Abby)	3:00pm-4:30pm PSY 224 (Chantal)		

Journal article + Final exam

- Journal article: **due on Monday December 8 by 11:59pm** (on Canvas). You may not touch AI (not even to brainstorm). If we think any content is AI-related, we will report it to the ODUS Committee on Discipline.
- Final exam: **4:00-5:30pm on Monday, December 15 in our usual room (McCosh 50)**. Those of you with ODS approval for extended time will take the exam in Peretsman Scully Hall. We'll be in touch.
 - Non-cumulative, beginning with the first lecture on language
 - Same format as the midterm, same number of questions: 20 Multiple choice, 12 fill in the blank, 1 short answer. You'll have much more time to complete this compared to the midterm.
 - Preceptors will hold extended office hours next week
 - Important note: sharing any exam content with a peer — this year or in the future — is a violation of the Honor Code. Pause and ask yourself if it's worth it.

WHY



WHY
DOES



WHY
DOES
THIS



WHY DOES THIS COURSE



WHY
DOES
THIS
COURSE
MATTER?



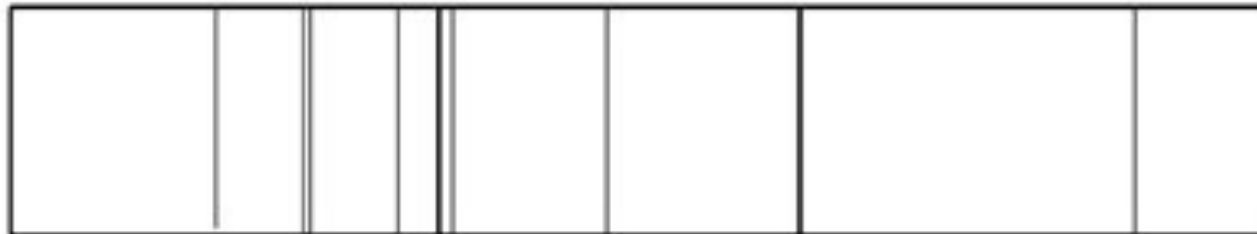




Carbon



Helium



Hydrogen

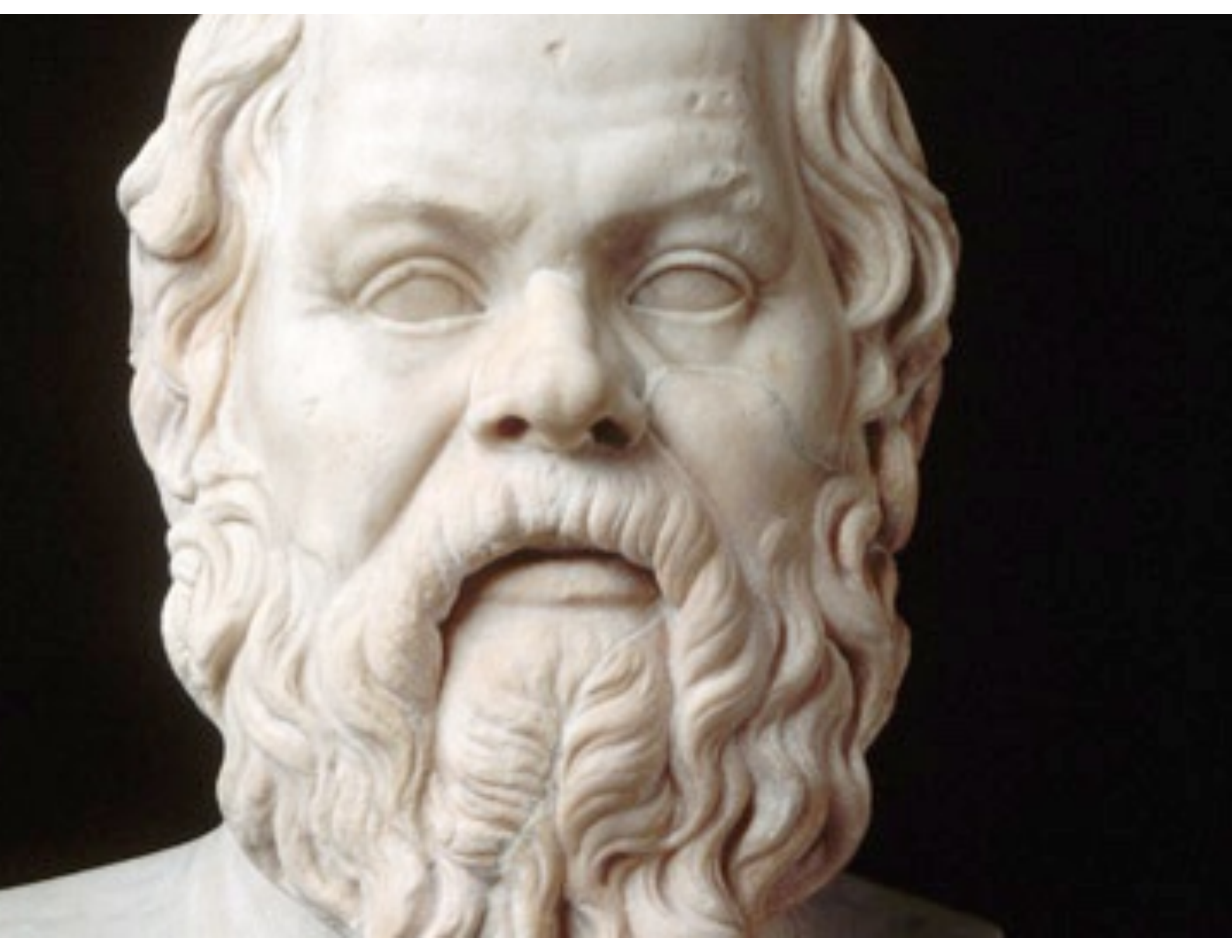


4,000
Blue

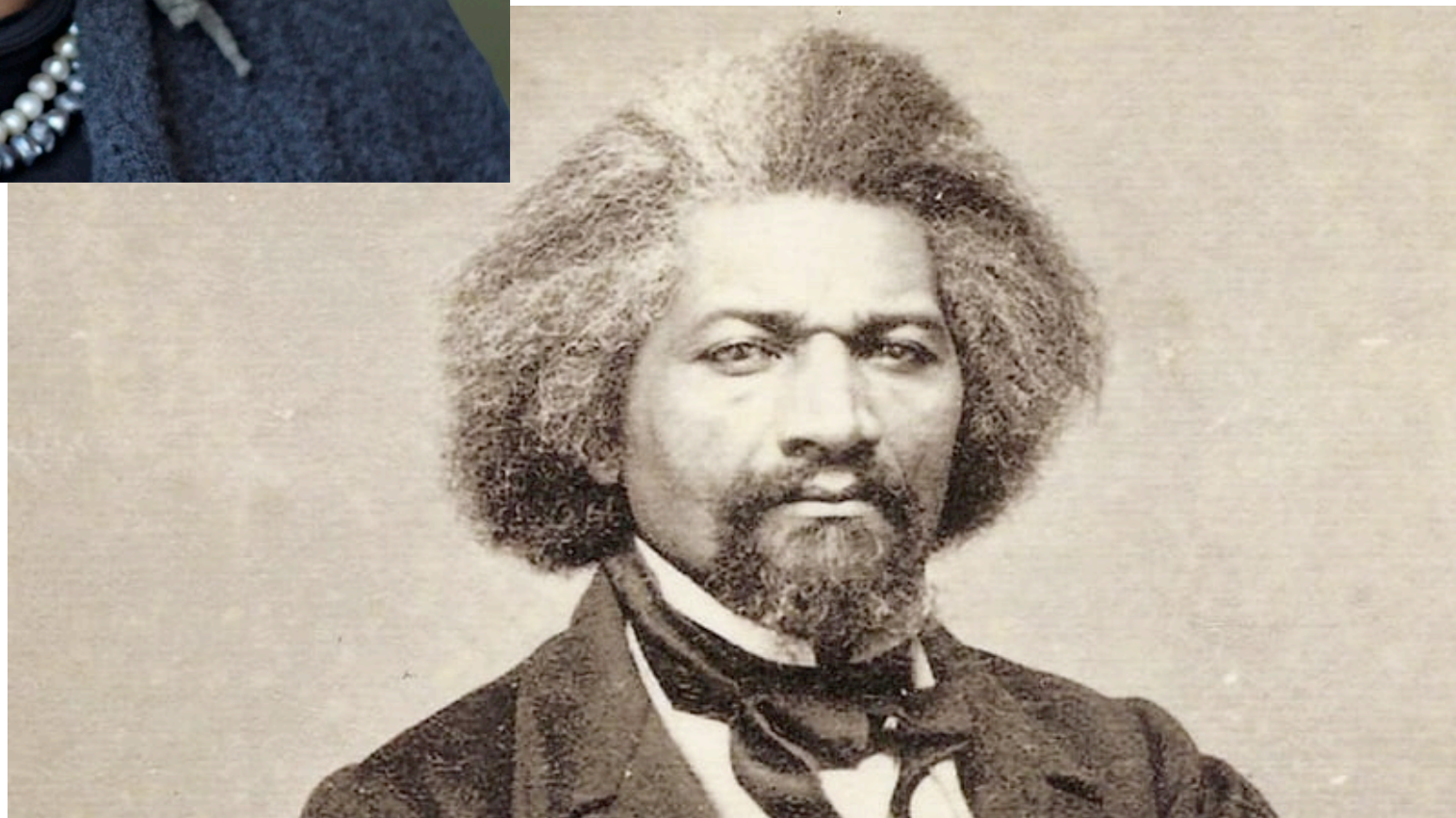
wavelength (Å)

7,000
Red











[illegible]







Architectural drawings of a window and door assembly, including a plan view and a section view. The plan view shows a window with a decorative frame and a door with a transom. The section view shows the vertical profile of the window and door, including the frame and the glass panes. Handwritten notes and dimensions are present throughout the drawings.

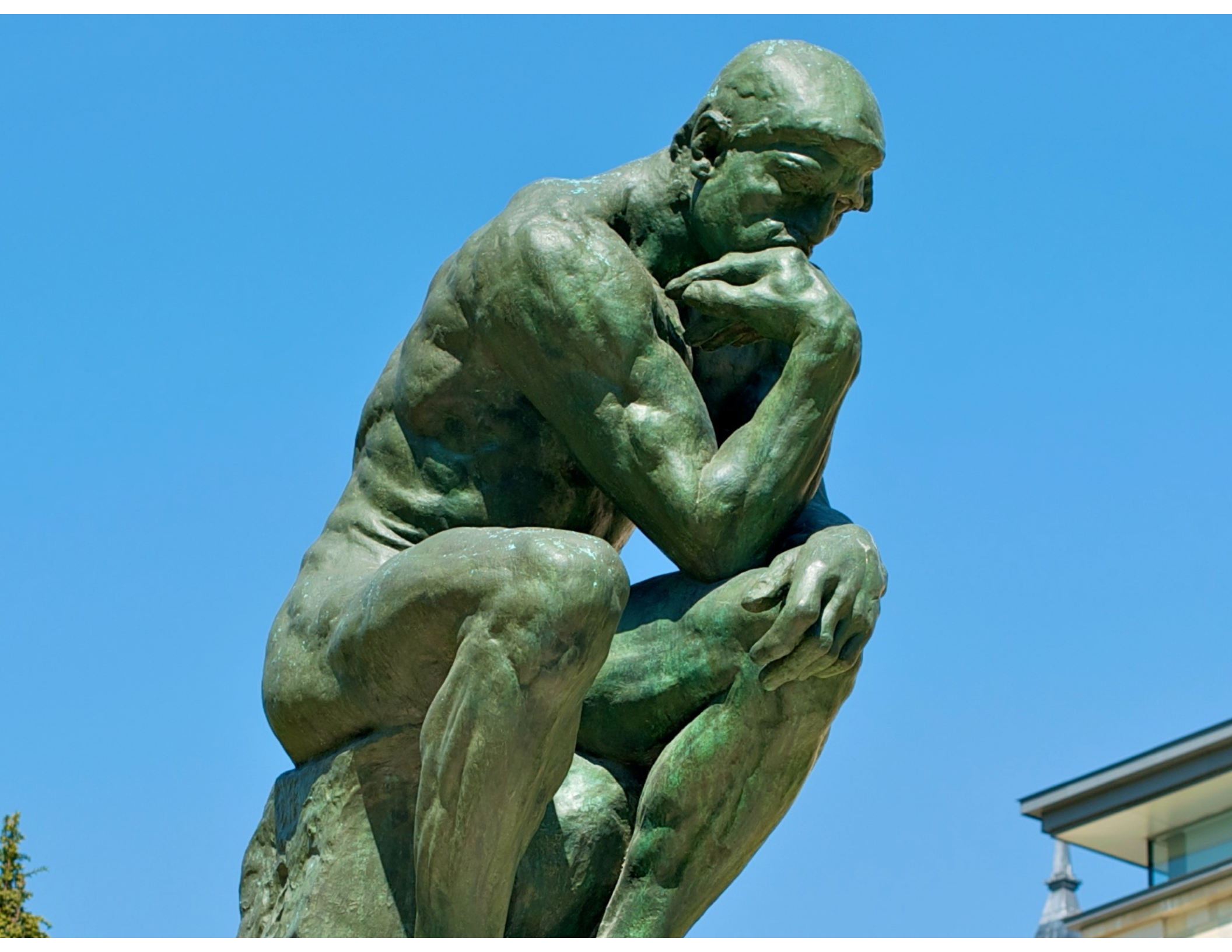
HISTORICAL SOCIETY
ME
JANUARY 10, 1904
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JANUARY 10, 1904

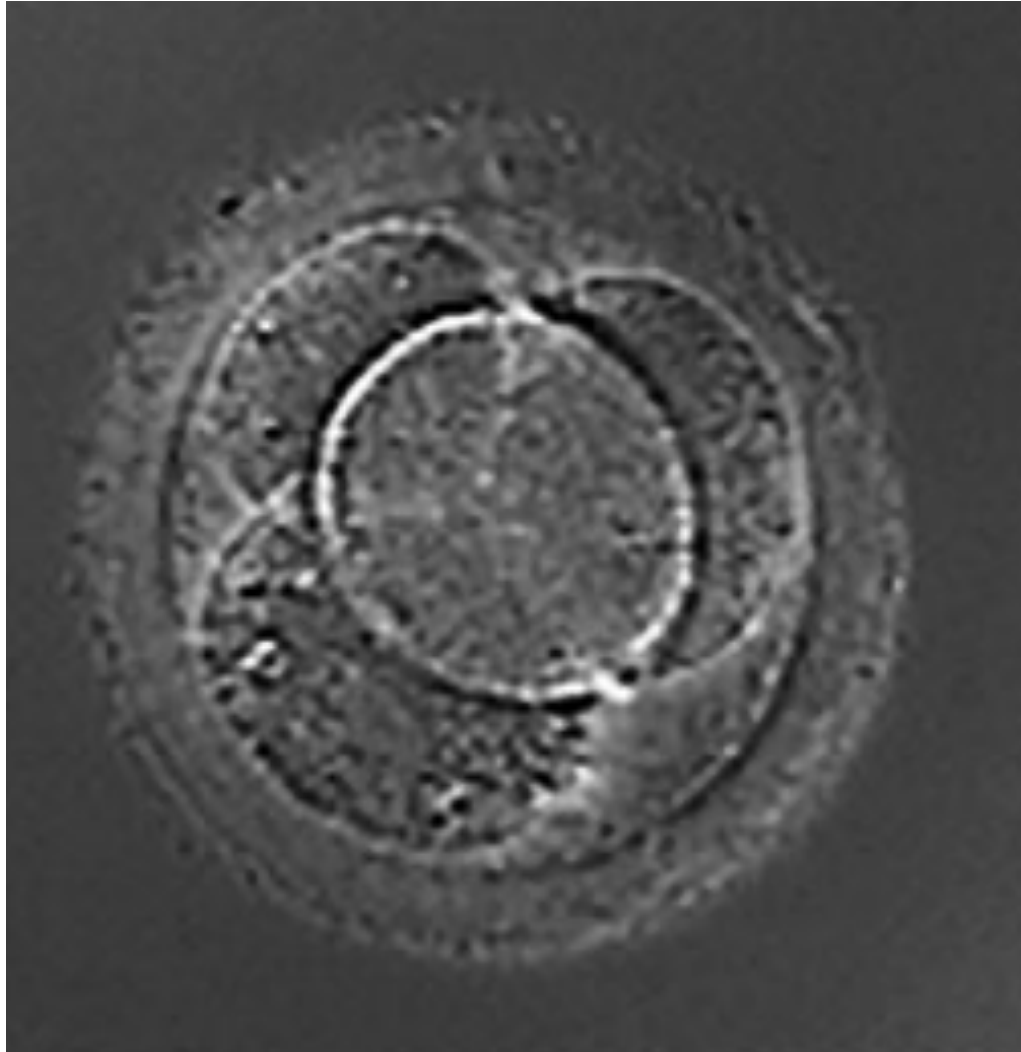
179

above









Why is developmental science a very complicated kind of science?

100 trillions atoms in a cell
30 trillion cells in your body
100 billion neurons in your brain
5 quadrillion square feet on Earth
X members in your family
X members in your social network
4096 tenth-great-grandparents
160 million seconds before kindergarten
Millions of bits of incoming data per second
Many thoughts, emotions, memories, words
Many social structures that govern us
Many reasons why we are how we are
Many ways to predict developmental outcomes

The questions we asked

T 9/2	1. What will happen in this course?	No readings
Precept 1		No readings
Th 9/4	2. Why study development?	Ch 1: 1-23
T 9/9	3. How do scientists study development and learning?	23-38, 53-55, 102, 173
Precept 2		Kisilevsky; MCQ due
Th 9/11	4. What's going on from -9 to +3 months?	Ch 2: all
T 9/16	5. How do the brain and body develop?	Ch 3: all
Precept 3		Gomez; MCQ due
Th 9/18	6. How do babies move?	Ch 5: 182-190, Ch 4: 154-159
T 9/23	7. How are children doing these days?	Any 3 news articles about children's wellbeing
Precept 4		Pascalis; Vogel; MCQ due
Th 9/25	8. How do babies sense and perceive?	Ch 5: 166-182
T 9/30	9. What are the most influential theories of cognitive development?	Ch 4: 122-136, 145-154
Precept 5	'Failing at Four' + any media article on early education;	MCQ due; Journal article topic due
Th 10/2	10. How do young children learn and remember?	Ch 4: 136-145, Ch 5: 190-198
T 10/7	11. What are the foundations of academic success?	Ch 7: 271-275, Ch 8: 280-296, 301-319
Precept 6		No readings
Th 10/9		Midterm exam (in class)

Enjoy fall break! 🍂

The questions we asked

T	10/21	12. How do babies break into the complexities of language?	Ch 6: 202-223
Precept 7		Saffran; 'Babies & A.I.' ; MCQ due	
Th	10/23	13. How do children learn words and process sentences?	Ch 6: 223-235
T	10/28	14. How important is early life experience? Hint: very.	218-219, 296-301, 452-462
Precept 8		Schwab; Journal article outline due; MCQ due	
Th	10/30	15. How does emotion develop in the first years of life?	Ch 10: 358-380, 386-392, Ch 9: 340
T	11/4	16. How does early experience vary across cultures? (<i>Babies</i> movie)	No readings
No precept. Enjoy this intentional mini-break! 🐼			
Th	11/6	17. How does attachment to parents shape development?	380-386, 396-408, 432-452
T	11/11	18. Why is play valuable?	254-256, 329-336, 468-470
Precept 9		Lansford; Difference vs. Deficit Debate; App/toy/book evaluation due; MCQ due	
Th	11/13	19. Do children have a sense of self?	Ch 9: 337-339, Ch 11: 408-420
T	11/18	20. Are children moral creatures? / Ask Casey anything	Ch 14: 496-519
Precept 10		Dweck; Warneken; MCQ due	
Th	11/20	21. What do children think about gender, SES, and race?	420-428, 470-473, Ch 15: all
No lectures or precepts during Thanksgiving week 🦃			
T	12/2	22. How do friends and screens influence development?	347-355, 468-488, 519-529
Precept 11		Strouse; Kirkorian; Media/art presentation due	
Th	12/4	23. WHY DOES THIS COURSE MATTER?	Ch. 16: all; 3 bullet points due

12/8 by 11:59pm: **Journal article due (on Canvas)**
 12/15 from 4-5:30pm: **Final exam**

Major themes in developmental psychology

- False dichotomies: innate vs. learned, nature vs. nurture, natural vs. cultural
 - Instead: something like 'Nature x Nurture'!
- Babies are amazing learners and they're also pathetic
- Change arises from multi-causal interactions across developmental systems and across time (i.e., dynamic systems)
- Continuity and discontinuity in development
- Parents AND the home/community environment AND peers AND genetics AND children themselves shape development
- Individual differences matter greatly
- What water is to fish, culture is to us





“Fast water”

Why does
development
matter?

Why does
this course
matter?

Science

Health

Human Diversity

Parenting

Education

Society

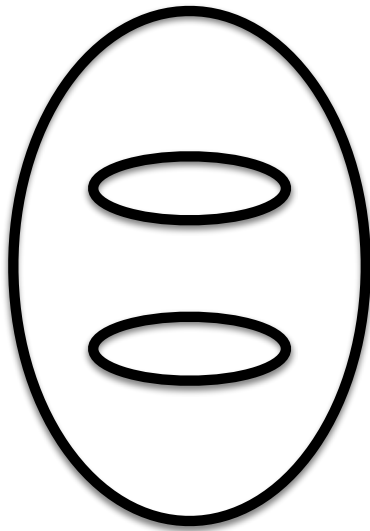
Why does development matter?

Understanding how learning works

- How on earth do humans learn so much?
- How do we go from detecting simple patterns to reasoning about philosophy?
- Our mental life contains everything from the taste of bad food to the idea of bad taste. How can so many thoughts nestle within a few pounds of tissue?



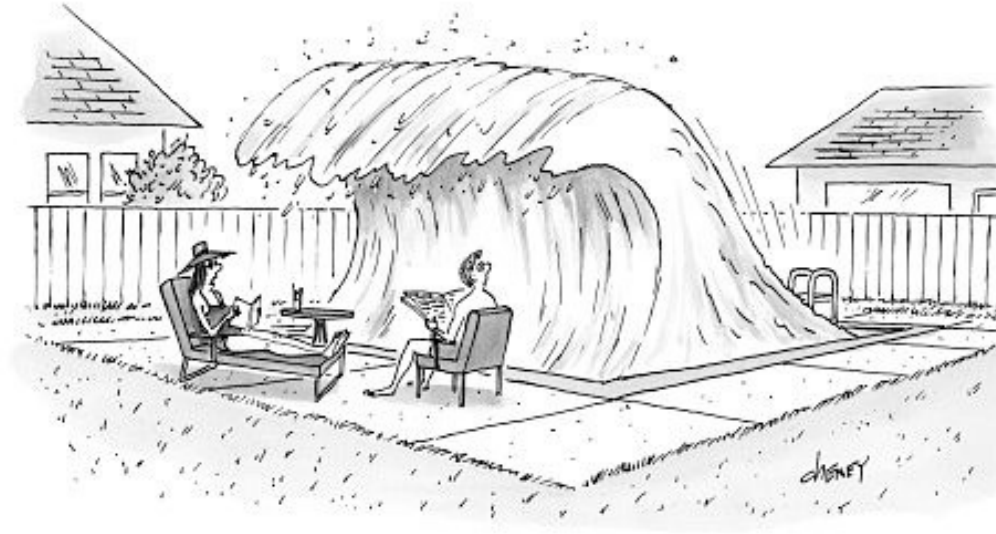
Why does development matter? **Higher cognition**



Two small horizontal ovals
in a larger ellipse.

Close-up of a pig
reading book titles at the library.

Why does development matter? **Higher cognition**



Why does development matter?

Informs our understanding of other branches of psychology

- Cognitive psychology
- Social psychology
- Cognitive neuroscience
- Educational psychology
- Clinical psychology
- Health psychology
- Industrial/organizational psychology
- Sport psychology
- Forensic psychology

Why does development matter?
Informs our understanding of other branches of psychology



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nkn3wRyb9Bk&t=5s>

Science

Health

Human Diversity

Parenting

Education

Society

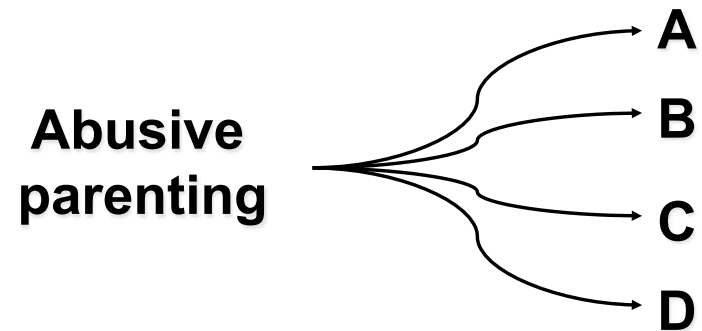
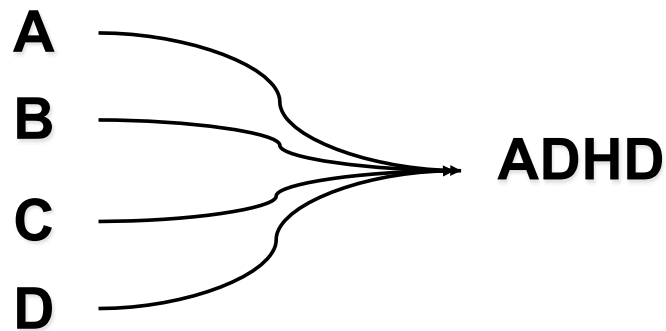
Why does development matter? **Promoting health**

- We should strive to promote the health and well-being of all children.
- How can we use developmental science to improve medical treatment for kids?
- How can health care professionals advocate for kids?



Why does development matter? **Disorders**

- Are childhood psychological disorders different from adult disorders?
- Who is the patient: the child or the family?
- Equifinality vs. multifinality



- How do we determine when development has gone awry? When is the problem transient? What do we measure and who do we ask? When should we intervene?



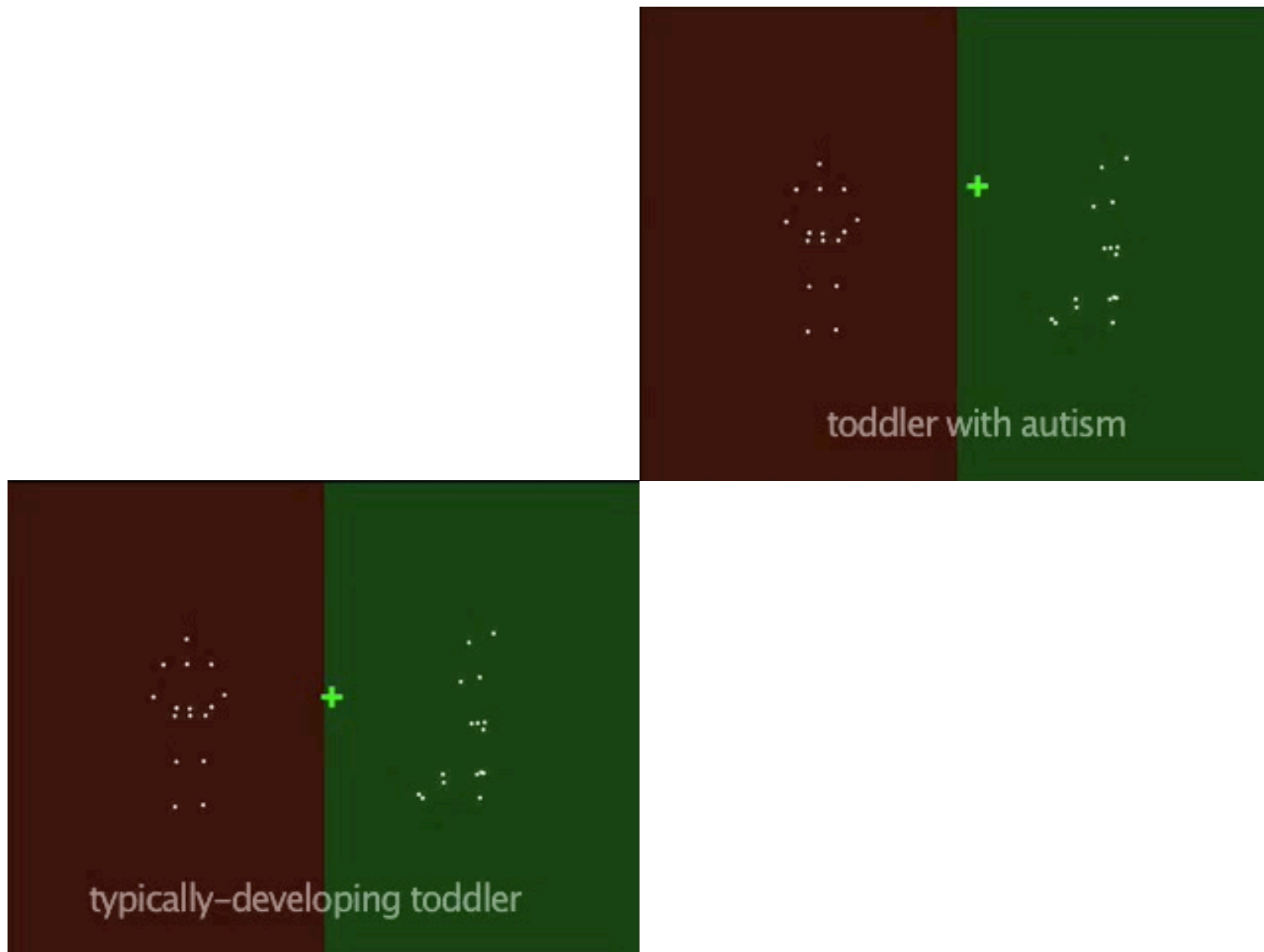
Why does development matter? **Disorders**

- **Down syndrome** is the most common genetic cause of intellectual disability
- Communication outcomes are highly variable
- There's a lot of controversy about genetic testing in utero



Why does development matter? **Disorders**

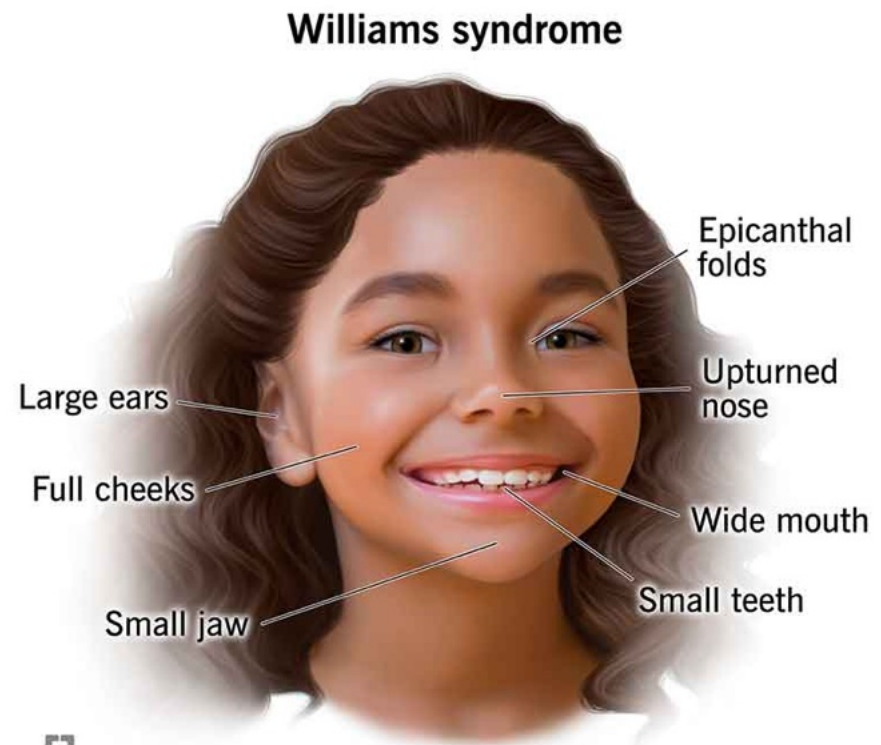
- **Autism spectrum disorders**
- Can we use infant measures to predict diagnosis?



Why does development matter? **Disorders**

- **Williams syndrome**

- Genetic disorder affecting 1 in 10,000 births
- Language: normal vocabulary, good grammar, creative language use, but poor conversational abilities
- Low IQ
- Highly sociable
- Highly musical
- Poor spatial skills



Science

Health

Human Diversity

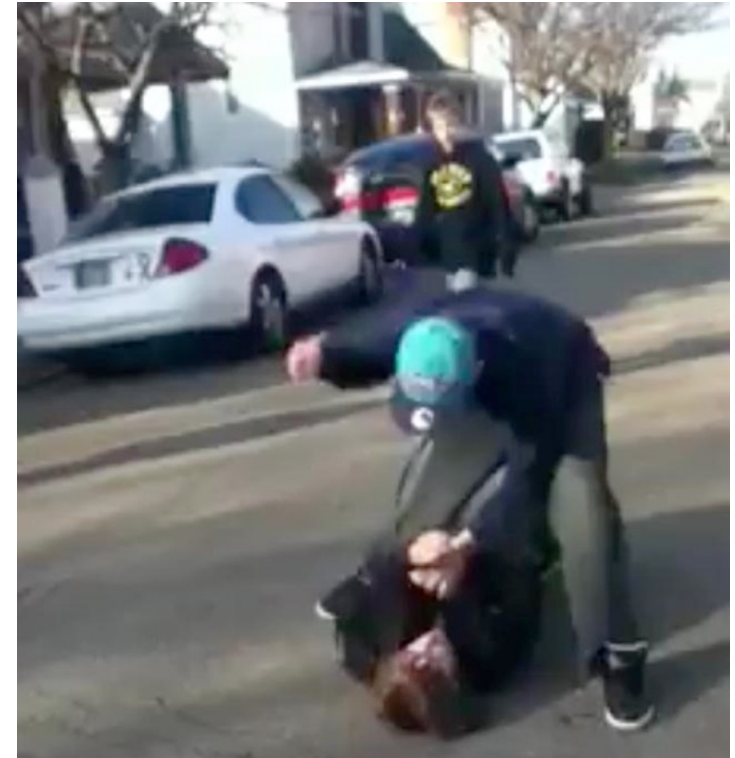
Parenting

Education

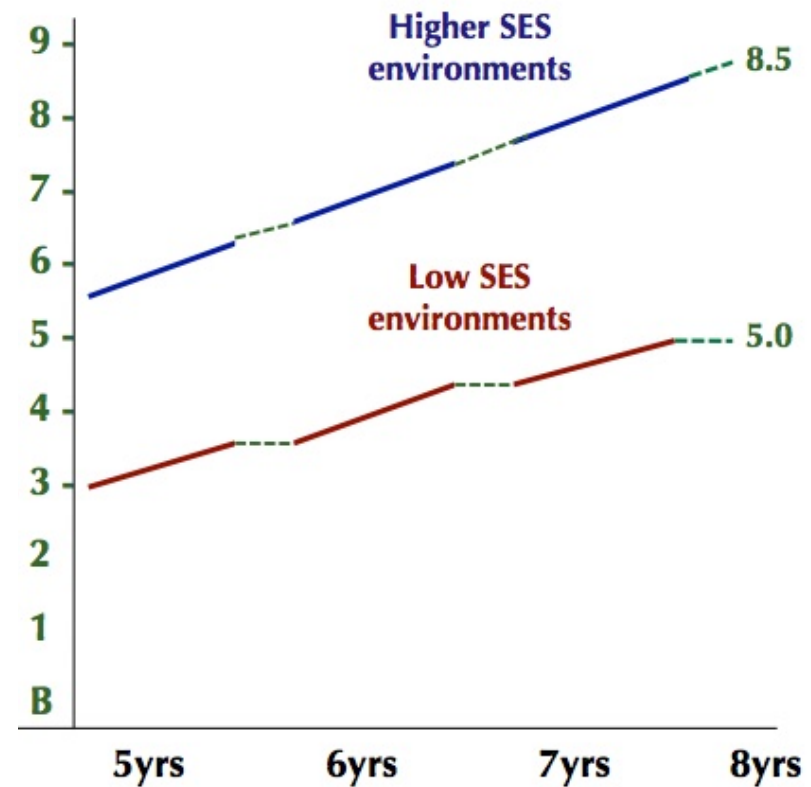
Society

Why does development matter? **Antisocial behavior**

- Aggression is related to:
 - low parental support
 - chaotic family environment
 - lack of monitoring a child's activities
 - abusive or inconsistent discipline
 - stress in the home
 - having antisocial peers
 - gene variants related to serotonin and dopamine
- Gene variants are related to higher risk for aggression in adverse situations (like maltreatment and divorce), but not in the absence of adverse conditions.
- Interventions that promote emotional understanding, prosocial behavior, self-control, and social problem-solving DO seem to work.

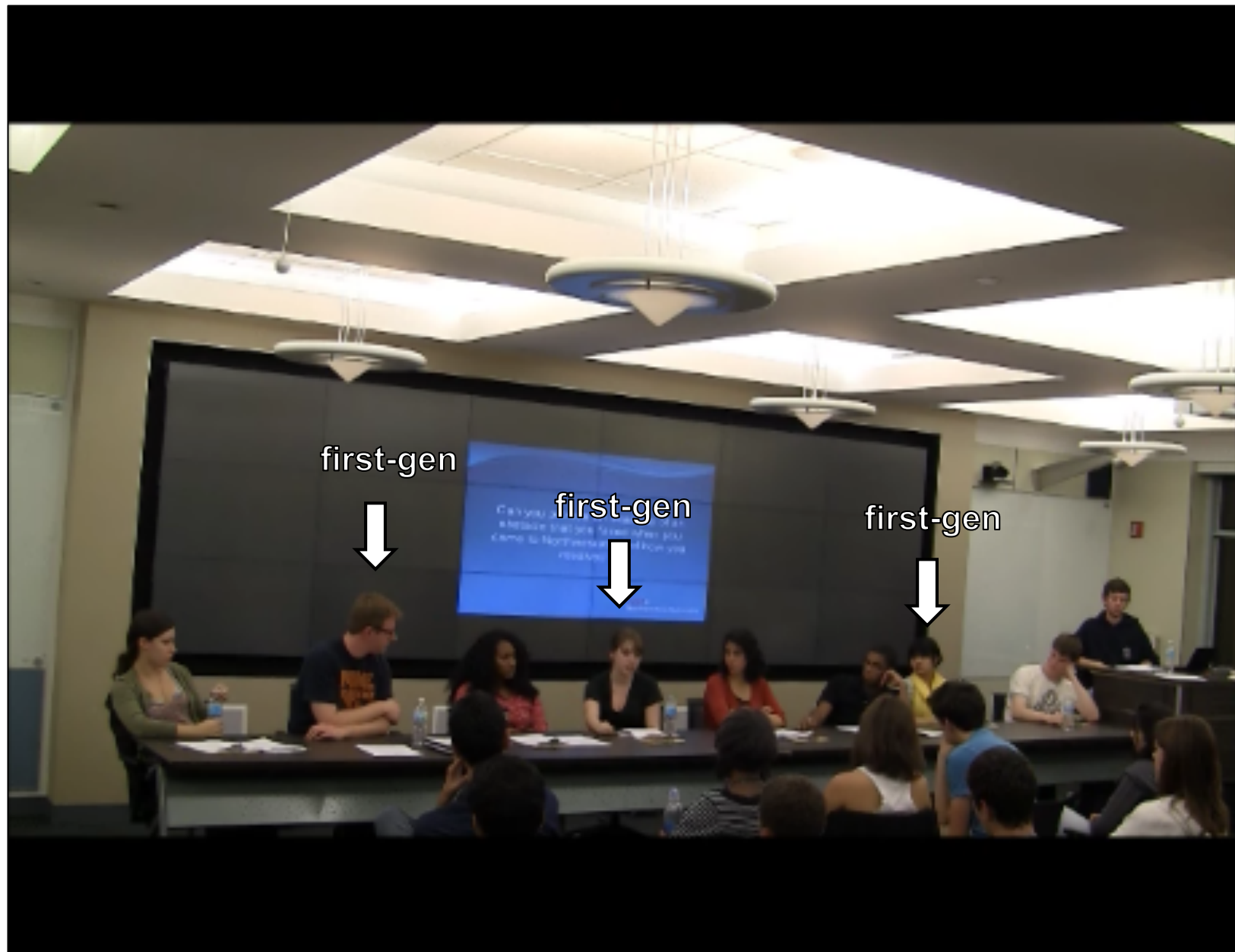


Why does development matter? **Poverty & the achievement gap**



Why does development matter?

Diversity, equity, inclusion



Why does development matter?

Diversity, equity, inclusion

- Why do people who care for children get paid less than almost anybody else? The full-time wage at even the best childcare centers is close to the poverty line.



- How can we promote racial justice across the lifespan?
- How can we better understand and respect people who are different from us? e.g., people from “other social groups”; homelessness

Why does development matter?

Diversity, equity, inclusion

- We can get rid of the ridiculous stereotype that girls are bad at math
- We can address the ridiculous gender gap in politics, engineering...

MATH IS HARD



Why does development matter? **Aging**

- Example: interacting with an age-progressed rendering of yourself leads people to engage in better financial planning.



- Older people focus more than young people on emotional well-being, and they have a positivity bias.

Science
Health
Human Diversity
Parenting
Education
Society

Why does development matter? **Parenting**

DAD'S HAVE A SHORT LIST OF THINGS THEY'LL BRAG ABOUT FOR THE REST OF THEIR LIVES. THIS IS ONE OF THEM



Why does development matter? **Parenting**

Please be a helper

vs.

Please help me



Why does development matter? **Parenting**

- How do you explain important and serious topics to your child?
 - How do you explain sex?
 - How do you explain shootings?
 - How do you explain that men of color are more likely to be killed by police?
 - How do you explain 9/11?
 - How do you explain the pandemic?
 - How do you explain massacres of people around the world?
 - How do you explain increasing political divisions?
 - How do you explain what happens in 20XX?



Why does development matter? **Parenting**

- **You need a license to fish, and you need to learn stuff to get a driver's license, but anyone can have & raise a baby**
- The only 'rule' (in the U.S. at least) is that you can't drive a baby home from the hospital without a car seat.
- Foster parents and adoptive parents have to go through training. Should a bit of education be mandated for biological parents? (basic info about crying, feeding, etc.)

Why does development matter? **Parenting**

- Many couples struggle to have biological children.
- Adoption and foster care are incredibly enriching paths for parenting.



- How can developmental science inform how to best support parents and children in the early stages of parenting?

Science

Health

Human Diversity

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Society

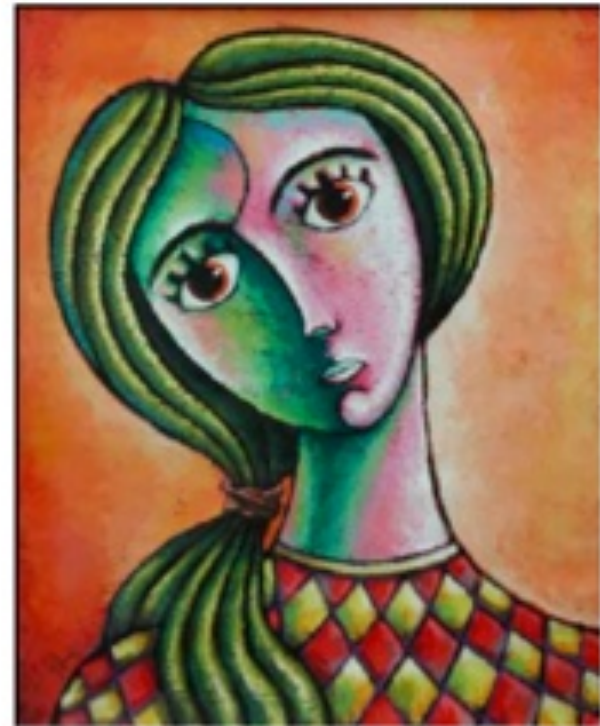
Why does development matter? **Education**

- Schools need to accommodate...
 - kids who learn differently
 - SES differences
 - kids learning a 2nd language



Why does development matter? **Education**

- The world is increasingly connected. How can we actively encourage bilingualism/biliteracy/biculturalism in kids?
- Is there a recipe of dual-language use in the home that can best promote bilingual proficiency?



Why does development matter? **Education**



My grandmother from California



My grandmother from Arkansas

Science
Health
Human Diversity
Parenting
Education
Society

Why does development matter? **Legal issues**

- When should kids be charged as adults?
- Who should get custody in divorce?
- Weighting biological parents vs. non-biological parents



Why does development matter? Legal issues



The National Children's
Advocacy Center

Forensic Interview Structure

STAGE 1

• **Introductions**

- » Introduce self/role
- » Age appropriate explanation of process
- » Answer questions/address concerns

• **Rapport**

- » Allow child to become more comfortable
- » Engage child in conversation about topics that are **interesting to the child**
- » Learn about child's interests and day-to-day life

• **Guidelines**

- » Explain guidelines/ground rules/expectations
 - Correct me
 - Don't know/don't guess
 - Don't understand
 - True and Real
- » Not helpful to all children (including very young children)
- » Some children benefit from practice

• **Narrative Practice**

- » Select topic(s) of interest
 - Forensic conversation about a non-forensic topic
 - In-depth discussion of 1 to 2 events (episodic memory training)
- » Invite child to "tell me all about..."
 - Set baseline by modeling narrative elaboration
 - Teach child about need for details in substantive phase
- » Listen without interruption
- » Follow with responses that encourage further description or ask for explanation

• **Family**

- » "Tell me about your family" or "Who lives with you?"
- » May be documented through drawing or listing names if it seems developmentally appropriate
- » May reveal concerns that need to be explored

The NCAC Child Forensic Interview Structure

provides guidelines for best practice based on research and expertise demonstrated in the field. The NCAC process is a flexible structure that allows for discretion in matters decided by state statutes and community practices.

STAGE 2

• **Transition**

- » Question(s) to invite child to discuss substantive issues
- » "Funneled" approach
 - Start with direct "How come you're here today" type of questions
 - Incremental approach starts broad and becomes progressively more focused
 - More direct prompts may or may not be used

• **Narrative description**

- » Open prompts that tap recall memory
- » Avoid rush to specific questions
- » Ask for explanation or further description

• **Follow-up questions**

- » Questions eliciting further details
- » Keep questions as open as possible
- » Cautious use of prompts that tap recognition memory
- » May not know the answers to all follow-up questions

• **Clarification**

- » Tools or techniques may be helpful for some children
- » Match any tool or technique to the ability level and personality of the child

• **Closure**

- » Return to everyday conversation or neutral topic discovered in rapport
- » Answer questions or concerns
- » Thank child for the participation, time, and effort (not content)

“In parenting, I’ve come to see why 18-year-olds should never be soldiers.”

- A friend of mine

Why does development matter? **Media and toys**

- Film/TV ratings for different ages
- Violent video games
- Social media (bullying, predators...)
- How do we make media educational?



Why does development matter? **Media and toys**

- Toys are everywhere. Fisher-Price distributes toys in >130 countries.
- Science can and should inform toy-making. There is so much potential for creating toys that promote interaction, learning, and cognition.
- Traditional toys vs. electronic/multi-function toys.



2025: **Kumma the GPT-enabled teddy bear**
“is the perfect friend for both kids and adults”.

... but it talked about sex fetishes, sex positions,
where to find knives, and how to light a match.

Why does development matter?
Informs the important work of nonprofits, museums, etc.



Big Brothers Big Sisters



the



Harlem Children's
Z O N E

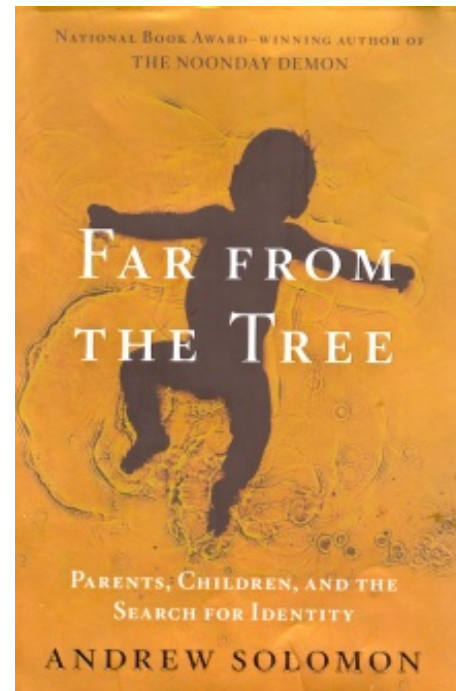
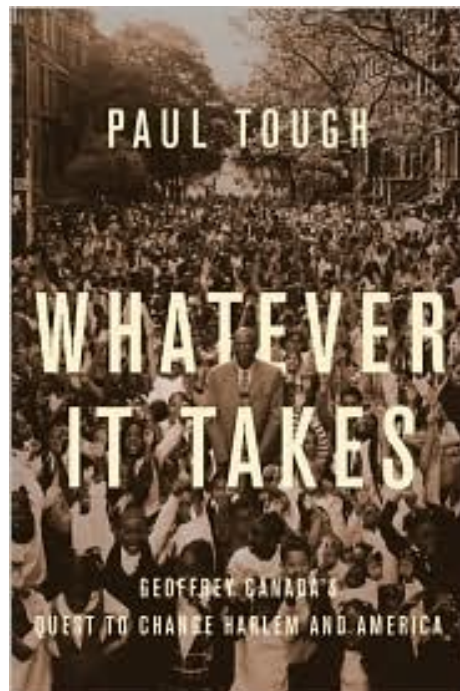
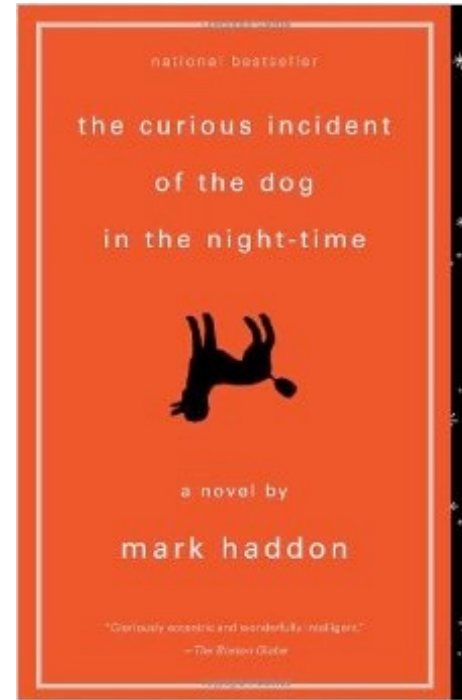
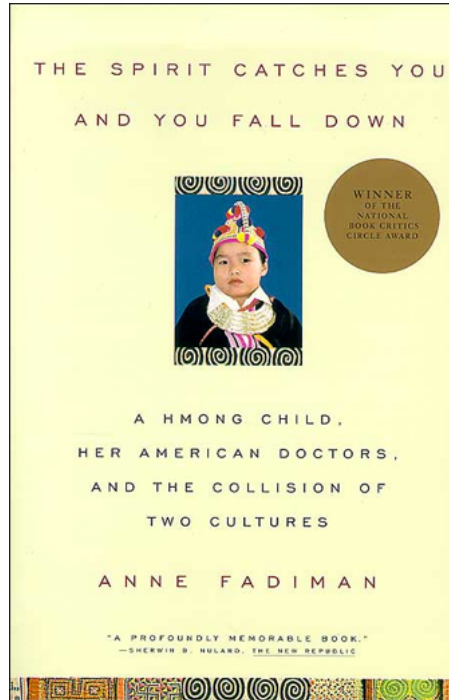


Don't forget the wonder of childhood.

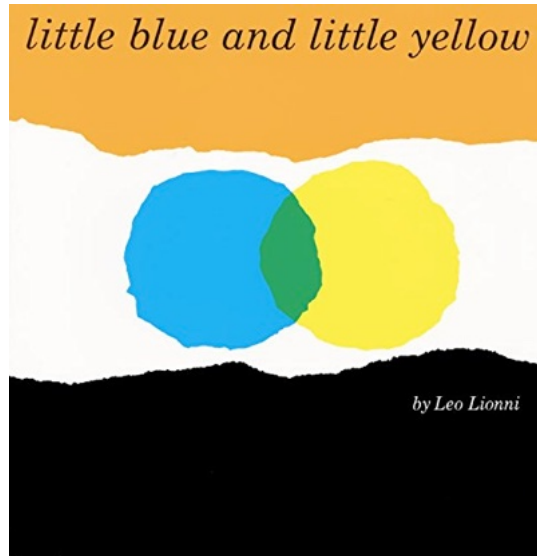
Rhiannah Gordon



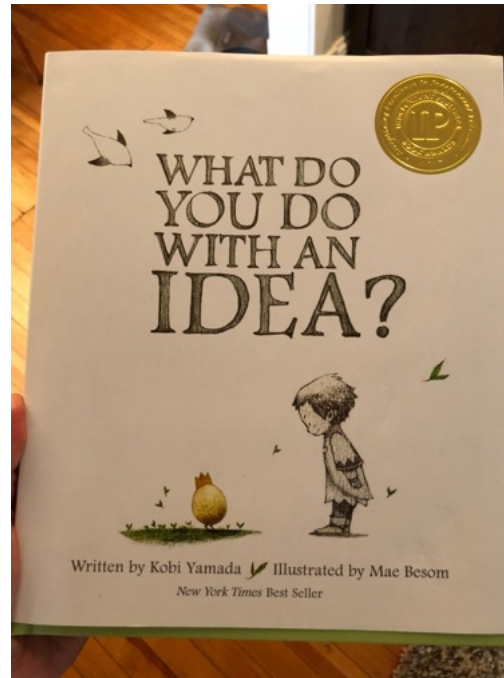
Book recommendations



A few of my favorite non-mainstream children's books



(for babies)

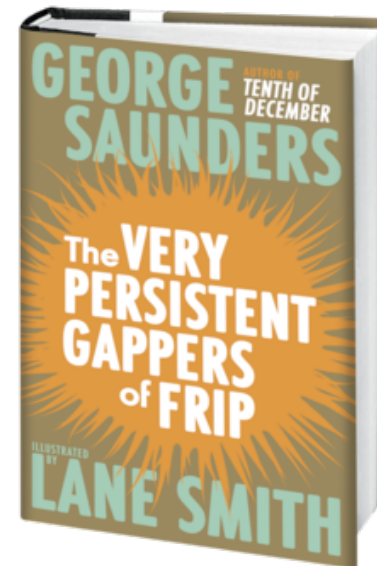


(maybe 3+)



(maybe 4+)

If you buy these soon or someday, let me know if kids in your life like them!



(maybe 6+)

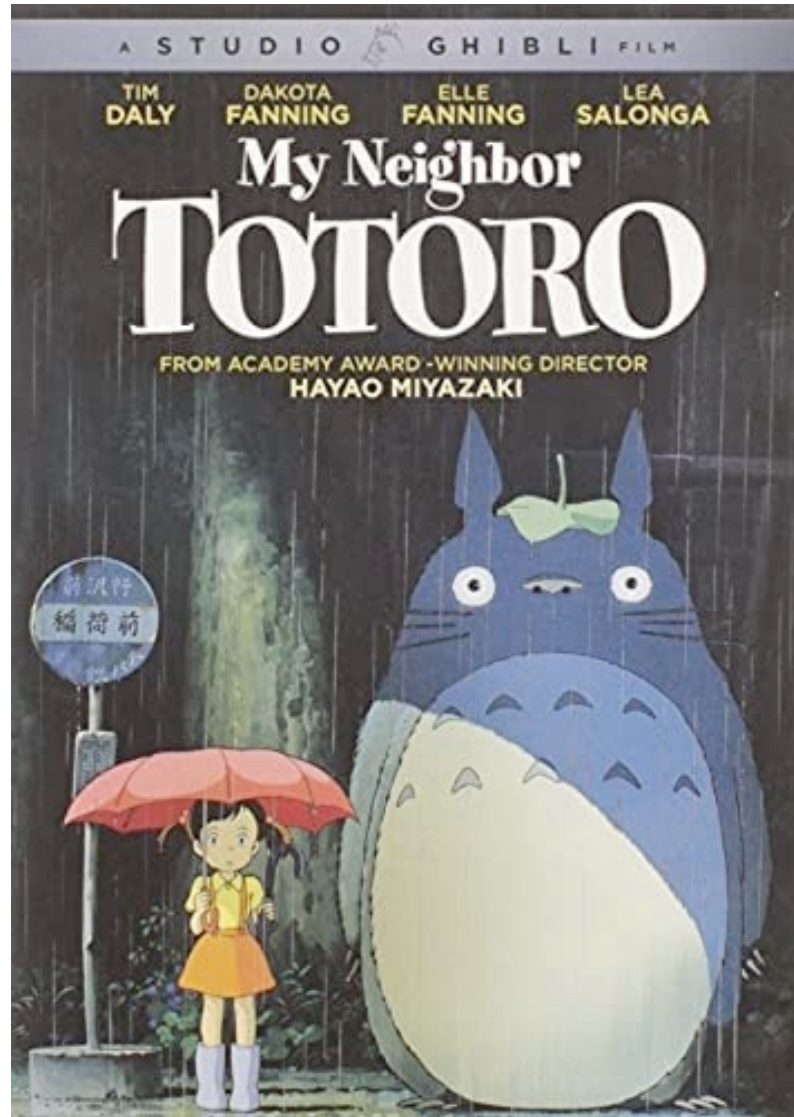
(note: this one is pretty weird/eerie, but amazing!)

Recommended movies



BEST FIRST MOVIE FOR ANY CHILD

Trust me. And please remember this.



(the English dubbed version and the original Japanese version are great)

This is a book that's named:
Worm on a Trip



This is a book that's named:
Worm on a Trip

And the worm saw
a book that was
named "Worm
on a Trip." And he
changed color.



et.



email me if you're interested in being
a research assistant!



el

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HnOllgd-8Ao>

Thanks for coming to office hours :)

Promise me you'll remember your 3 things!

FOR

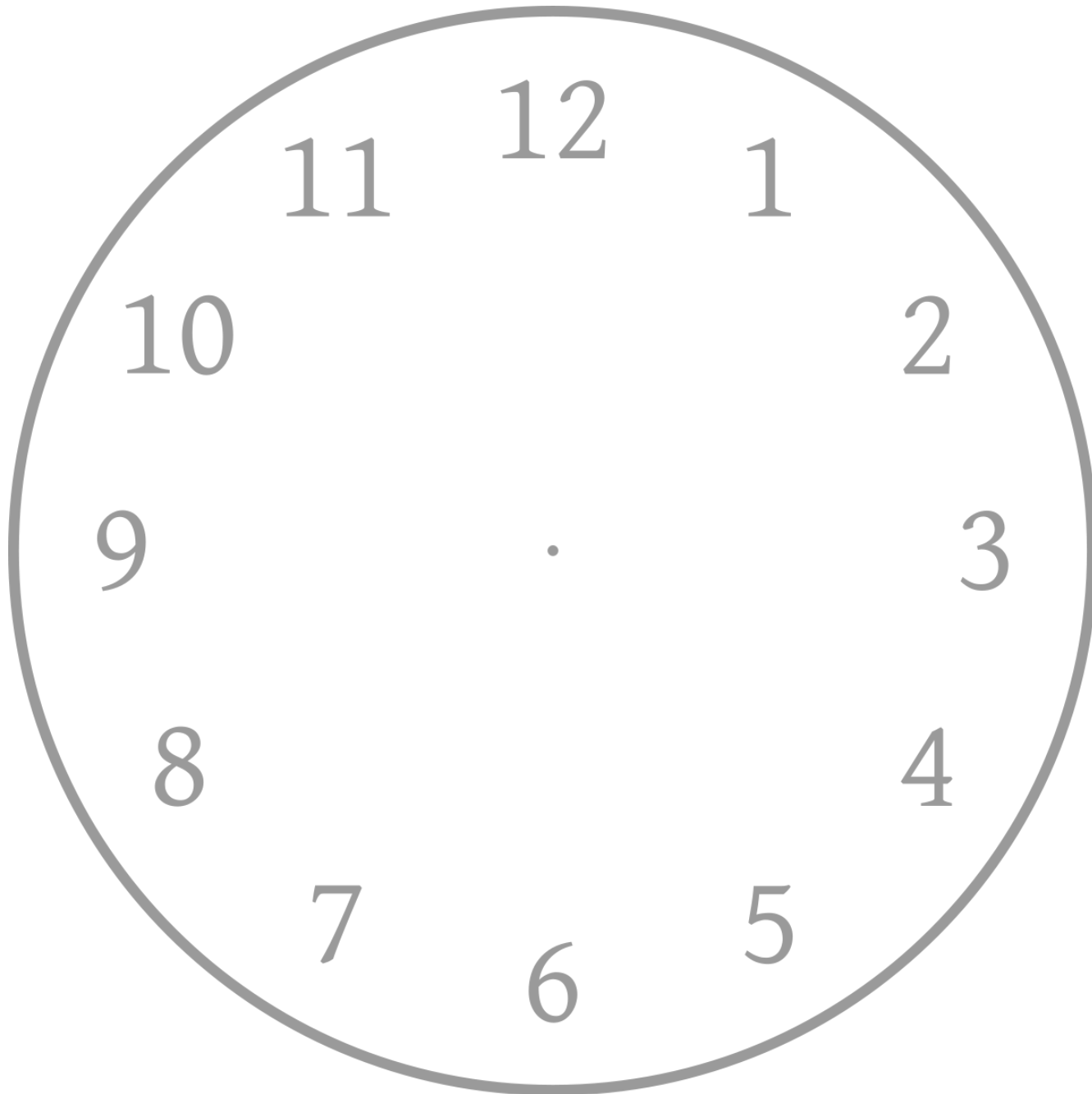
A black and white photograph of a hand with fingers spread, overlaid with a large red 'FOR' text and a diagonal red line.

ANVIER

Say hi at reunions!
Stop me on the street in NY!



My hope for you all







Kennedy Casey



Abby Fergus



Sarah Joo



Chantal Valdivia



Claire Whiting

